

MADRAS SCHOOL OF SOCIAL WORK

WEEKLY RECORDS OF FIELDWORK

Name of the Agency: Union Bank of India, Regional Office Chennai South, Royapettah **Name of the Student:** Sreetama Ghosh Ray **Year:** ____ **Term:** ____

Initial Posting — Union Bank of India, Chennai North Zonal Office (19/08/2026 to 25/08/2026)

S.No	Day & Date	Nature of Work Done	Learning / Takeaway	Hours
1	Wednesday 19/08/2026	Reported at the Chennai North Zonal Office for the initial posting and was welcomed by the staff. Received a detailed briefing on the scope and functions of the Zonal Office, its reporting relationship with the Central Office and the several Regional Offices working under it. Was also introduced to activities the bank undertakes beyond regular banking, including "The Hindu Made of Chennai Run 2026," a community running event associated with Chennai, covered in <i>The Hindu</i> , with the event scheduled for 23 August 2026. Spent time going through internal notices and getting familiar with the office layout and staff.	Bank engages in community initiatives beyond core banking.	8 hrs
2	Thursday 20/08/2026	Continued orientation at the Zonal Office. Observed how the front office, administrative section and various functional desks operate together on a typical working day, and how instructions and information flow between the Zonal Office and the Regional Offices reporting to it. Sat in on informal discussions among staff regarding pending correspondence and files awaiting clearance, which gave a sense of the volume and variety of matters handled at this level.	Zonal, Regional and branch levels coordinate closely.	8 hrs
3	Friday 21/08/2026	Continued exposure to Zonal Office functioning, with particular attention to how the office monitors and supports the Regional Offices under its jurisdiction. Reviewed, at a general level, how performance parameters, targets and compliance matters are tracked	Zonal Office oversight spans multiple regions.	8 hrs

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		across the region, without access to any confidential figures or records.		
4	Saturday 22/08/2026	4th Saturday – attended office as a working day and continued the general orientation begun earlier in the week, including further familiarisation with office procedures and daily routines.	—	8 hrs
5	Sunday 23/08/2026	Weekly holiday.	—	—
6	Monday 24/08/2026	Continued at the Zonal Office while formally initiating the process of relocation to Regional Office Chennai South. The distance between residence and the Zonal Office, along with the daily commute time involved, made regular attendance difficult, and this was discussed with the concerned officials so that a more feasible placement could be arranged.	Practical constraints (distance/travel) can affect internship placement.	8 hrs
7	Tuesday 25/08/2026	Final day at the Zonal Office before the approved relocation to Regional Office Chennai South, Royapettah. Completed handover formalities, thanked the officials for their guidance during this initial period, and noted down the key points learnt about the Zonal Office's functioning for future reference in the dissertation work.	Initial exposure gave a useful base before RO fieldwork.	8 hrs

Total: 48 hrs

Week 1 — Joined Regional Office Chennai South, Royapettah (26/08/2026 to 30/08/2026)

S.No	Day & Date	Nature of Work Done	Learning / Takeaway	Hours
1	Wednesday 26/08/2026	Joined Regional Office Chennai South, Royapettah, and was given an initial orientation by the HR team. Was taken through the bank's overall administrative hierarchy in detail – Head/Central Office, Zonal Office, Regional Office and branches – along with how responsibilities for policy-making, implementation and day-to-day administration are distributed across these levels. Also given	HR in a PSU bank operates across multiple administrative levels.	8 hrs

S.No	Day & Date	Nature of Work Done	Learning / Takeaway	Hours
		a walkthrough of the different sections functioning within the Regional Office building.		
2	Thursday 27/08/2026	Attended the morning Hindi prayer session followed by the daily reading of circulars covering the bank's overall performance, profitability, non-performing assets, policy instructions from the Head Office and upcoming mandatory training requirements. Was introduced in detail to the HR function of the Regional Office, which is responsible for staff welfare, attendance monitoring, leave administration and transfers for approximately 75 branches falling under this region.	Daily circulars keep employees informed of priorities and training needs.	8 hrs
3	Friday 28/08/2026	Learnt how major centralised functions such as recruitment, overall salary structure, employee benefits and industrial-relations policy are decided at the Head Office in Mumbai, while the Regional Office is responsible for implementing these policies locally – processing salary, permissible allowances, conveyance claims, and travel and accommodation reimbursements for employees travelling on official work between branches.	RO translates Head Office policy into day-to-day administration.	8 hrs
4	Saturday 29/08/2026	Studied the leave-sanctioning procedure in detail, including how routine leave is sanctioned directly at the Regional Office while longer categories such as maternity, sabbatical or study leave require approval from a higher authority. An officer, using a temporary access ID granted for this purpose, demonstrated in a limited manner how leave records are maintained and how they are reflected in the salary-processing system.	Confidentiality and access control are strictly maintained.	8 hrs
Total: 32 hrs				

Week 2 — 31/08/2026 to 06/09/2026

S.No	Day & Date	Nature of Work Done	Learning / Takeaway	Hours
1	Monday 31/08/2026	Learnt the transfer policy applicable to bank staff, including the distinction between inter-state transfers (which involve management, employee unions and the Head Office) and transfers between branches within the same region (which are handled by the Regional Office itself). Also understood the broad outline of the disciplinary procedure – reporting of an issue, examination by the concerned authority and, where necessary, a formal inquiry – and reviewed circulars from the Learning & Development wing relating to hybrid and mandatory training programmes.	Transfers and discipline follow defined authority levels.	8 hrs
2	Tuesday 01/09/2026	Received exposure to the Rural and Agriculture Business Department (RABD), which is responsible for agricultural lending, rural development initiatives and government-sponsored schemes. Understood the concept and importance of Priority Sector Lending (PSL), under which banks are required to extend credit to identified sectors such as agriculture, micro, small and medium enterprises, education, housing and weaker sections of society, and how this supports financial inclusion.	PSL links banking to financial inclusion, not just commercial goals.	8 hrs
3	Wednesday 02/09/2026 to Saturday 05/09/2026	Medical Leave	—	—

Total: 16 hrs

Week 3 — 07/09/2026 to 13/09/2026

S.No	Day & Date	Nature of Work Done	Learning / Takeaway	Hours
1	Monday 07/09/2026 to Friday 11/09/2026	Medical Leave	—	—
2	Saturday 12/09/2026	2nd Saturday – Bank Holiday	—	—

Total: 0 hrs

Week 4 — 14/09/2026 to 20/09/2026

S.No	Day & Date	Nature of Work Done	Learning / Takeaway	Hours
1	Monday 14/09/2026	Resumed the internship after medical leave and was briefed on developments during the absence. Received a detailed overview of Currency Chest operations, including cash distribution, documentation, verification procedures, security arrangements and regulatory compliance requirements, as well as the bank's broader security setup covering guards, CCTV coverage, alarm systems, fire-safety measures and emergency-response procedures. Spent the remainder of the day planning the schedule for the upcoming branch visits for dissertation data collection.	Security and cash-handling functions underpin operational trust.	8 hrs
2	Tuesday 15/09/2026	Began primary data collection for the dissertation on Hybrid Learning and Training Effectiveness. Finalised and administered the research questionnaire among employees of Regional Office departments, including Retail Loans and Currency Chest, taking care throughout to avoid seeking any customer-related or confidential internal information from respondents.	Research must exclude confidential/customer data.	8 hrs
3	Wednesday 16/09/2026	Visited Triplicane 1, Triplicane 2 and Triplicane 3 branches and collected questionnaire responses from officers and clerical staff at each location. Particularly noted that Triplicane 2 was operating with a very limited staff strength – just two officers and one cashier – which visibly affected how much time employees could spare for a detailed discussion, let alone for scheduled training.	Staffing gaps limit time available for training.	8 hrs
4	Thursday 17/09/2026	Visited Alandur and Teynampet branches for further data collection. At Alandur, had an extended and valuable interaction with an experienced manager who had previously served in the armed forces, who spoke at length about the need for	Training covers soft skills, not just technical knowledge.	8 hrs

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		employees to continuously update themselves on banking practices, products, technology and, importantly, customer-facing skills. Teynampet, despite being a comparatively large branch, had only a few officers available at the time of the visit.		
5	Friday 18/09/2026	Visited Mowbrays Road, Chamiers Road and Mylapore 1 branches. Held detailed discussions with officers and clerical staff on the training methods they had personally experienced over the years – classroom-based programmes, self-paced online modules and live-streamed sessions – and gathered their honest opinions on how useful each mode had been for their actual day-to-day work.	Employees value different training modes differently.	8 hrs
6	Saturday 19/09/2026	Visited Mylapore 2 and Mylapore 3 branches and collected the remaining questionnaire responses for this cluster. Deliberately approached employees in between customer transactions and during comparatively quieter periods so that normal branch operations and customer service were not disturbed by the research activity.	Data collection must work around live customer service.	8 hrs

Total: 48 hrs

Week 5 – 21/09/2026 to 27/09/2026

S.No	Day & Date	Nature of Work Done	Learning / Takeaway	Hours
1	Monday 21/09/2026	Visited Adyar, Madhya Kailash and Besant Nagar 1 branches. Held detailed discussions with staff on their training experiences both before and after the amalgamation of Andhra Bank and Corporation Bank with Union Bank of India, and how they personally went about adapting to new systems, software and reporting formats introduced following the merger.	Mergers require sustained re-training, not a one-time briefing.	8 hrs

S.No	Day & Date	Nature of Work Done	Learning / Takeaway	Hours
2	Tuesday 22/09/2026	Visited Besant Nagar 2, Indiranagar and Shastri Nagar branches and collected detailed responses from both officers and clerical staff regarding their general perception of how effective the training programmes offered to them had actually been in practice.	Perceived usefulness varies by role and branch.	8 hrs
3	Wednesday 23/09/2026	Visited T. Nagar 1, T. Nagar 2 and T. Nagar 3 branches. Gathered detailed employee views comparing classroom, online and live-streamed training formats, with particular emphasis on how far employees felt able to apply what they had learnt to their actual day-to-day responsibilities at the counter and back office.	Application at work matters more than mode of delivery.	8 hrs
4	Thursday 24/09/2026	Visited West Mambalam and Nungambakkam branches. Carefully observed how customer footfall and general workload at these branches made it genuinely difficult for staff to step away for classroom training, and how digital and self-paced modules were, in practice, the more workable option in such settings.	High footfall branches lean more on digital/flexible learning.	8 hrs
5	Friday 25/09/2026	Visited Koyambedu, Virugambakkam and Saligramam branches. Discussed at length how employees who had originally come from the legacy Andhra Bank and Corporation Bank had to familiarise themselves with the common Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) of the merged entity, covering documentation, authorisation levels and customer service standards.	Common SOPs need active learning support to take hold.	8 hrs
6	Saturday 26/09/2026	4th Saturday – Bank Holiday	—	—

Total: 40 hrs

Week 6 — 28/09/2026 to 04/10/2026

S.No	Day & Date	Nature of Work Done	Learning / Takeaway	Hours
1	Monday 28/09/2026	Visited Ashok Nagar 1, Ashok Nagar 2 and Ashok Nagar 3 branches, thereby completing branch-level data collection across all 27 branches planned for the dissertation. Also made general observations on how employee and industrial relations are handled at the branch level, based on informal conversations with staff during the visit.	Broad sampling captures variation across branch sizes.	8 hrs
2	Tuesday 29/09/2026	Conducted follow-up interactions with several respondents to clarify a few ambiguous answers and carefully checked all the collected questionnaires for completeness and internal consistency before moving on to compilation.	Data verification is essential before analysis.	8 hrs
3	Wednesday 30/09/2026	Spent the day at the Regional Office learning about employee relations and general workplace practices there, including how internal communication is handled, how employee welfare concerns are addressed and how routine industrial-relations matters are managed on a day-to-day basis.	Good IR depends on communication and timely welfare support.	8 hrs
4	Thursday 01/10/2026	Documented the field observations gathered across all the branch visits in a structured format and compiled the questionnaire responses into a single dataset in preparation for detailed analysis.	Timely documentation improves analysis accuracy.	8 hrs
5	Friday 02/10/2026	Gandhi Jayanti – Public Holiday	—	—
6	Saturday 03/10/2026	Consolidated the collected data further and began noting down the main emerging findings relating to hybrid learning and training effectiveness for use in the dissertation report.	Findings link fieldwork directly to dissertation objectives.	8 hrs
Total: 40 hrs				

Week 7 — 05/10/2026 to 06/10/2026

S.No	Day & Date	Nature of Work Done	Learning / Takeaway	Hours
1	Monday 05/10/2026	Completed the remaining pending observations from the branch visits and finalised the research data collected over the preceding weeks, in preparation for the conclusion of the internship.	Closing fieldwork cleanly supports reliable reporting.	8 hrs
2	Tuesday 06/10/2026	Final day of the internship. Spent the day consolidating the key learnings from the entire internship period, reviewing the overall data collected for the dissertation, and formally thanking the officials of the Regional Office for their continuous guidance, cooperation and support throughout the internship.	Continuous training is central to adapting in banking.	8 hrs

Total: 16 hrs

Grand Total (19/08/2026 – 06/10/2026): 30 working days, 240 hrs

Student: _____ Faculty Supervisor: _____

Faculty Supervisor's Remarks (if any): _____